Enrique Acosta, Ph.D.

Curriculum vitae, October 2026

Enrique Acosta is a *Ramón y Cajal* Research Fellow and Established Research Scientist (R3) at the *Centre d'Estudis Demogràfics* (CED, Barcelona) and an Affiliate Researcher at the *Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research* (MPIDR, Rostock). Enrique is a demographer specializing in mortality analysis and the demography of crises, including violence, armed conflict, epidemics, and behavioral causes of death. His research focuses on developing innovative approaches to estimating excess mortality, analyzing bereavement, and modeling age-period-cohort effects. His work has been published in leading scientific journals, including *Nature*, *Science Advances*, *PNAS*, *Demography*, *Population and Development Review*, and *International Journal of Epidemiology*. As a member of Technical Advisory Groups (TAG) for the WHO (COVID-19 Mortality), the UN Inter-agency Group for Child Mortality Estimation (UN-IGME), and Colombia's National Statistical System (SEN), he leads the excess-mortality analysis that feeds the UN's flagship "Levels & Trends in Child Mortality" reports (2021–2025).

Bibliometrics (Google Scholar, October 2026): 28 peer-reviewed articles, most in Q1; 1,281 citations; h-index 15; i10-index 21.

Contact Information

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Google Scholar | Research Gate | OSF | GitHub | LinkedIn | ORCID ID 0000-0001-6250-4018

Current Positions

Research Scientist (R3 - *Ramón y Cajal*) (2022 –)
Centre d'Estudis Demogràfics (CED), Barcelona, Spain
Affiliate Researcher (2022 –)
Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research (MPIDR), *Kinship Inequalities Research Group*. Rostock, Germany

Former Positions

Research Scientist (2019 – 2022)
MPIDR, Rostock, Germany
SSHRC and *FRQSC* Postdoctoral Fellow (2020 – 2021)
Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) of Canada
Fonds de recherche du Québec–Société et culture (FRQSC)
Joseph-Armand Bombardier Fellow (2015 - 2018)
Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) of Canada

Education

Ph.D. in Demography (2019) – *Université de Montréal*, Canada – *MPIDR*, Germany
Doctoral dissertation: "Age, period, and cohort effects on adult mortality due to extrinsic causes of death."
M.Sc. in Demography (2014) – *Université de Montréal*, Canada
B.A. (Hons) in Sociology (2008) – *Universidad Nacional de Colombia*, Colombia
B.Eng. (Hons) in Industrial Engineering (2007) – *Universidad Distrital de Bogotá*, Colombia

Selected publications

1. **2026 Acosta, Enrique*,** Diego Alburez-Gutierrez*, Maria Gargiulo, and Catalina Torres. "Weaponizing Kinship: A Demographic Analysis of Bereavement in the Colombian Conflict." ***Population and Development Review*** 52 (3).
   ***** [Acosta and Alburez-Gutiérrez contributed equally]
2. **2026** Fortes De Lena, Fernanda, Samuel Araujo Gomes da Silva, and **Enrique Acosta**. "Same-Sex Marriage in Times of Political Uncertainty: Evidence from Brazil." ***Population and Development Review*** 0 (0).
3. **2025** Gómez-Ugarte, Ana C., Irena Chen, **Enrique Acosta,** Ugofilippo Basellini, and Diego Alburez-Gutierrez. "Accounting for uncertainty in conflict mortality estimation: An application to the Gaza War in 2023-2024." ***Population Health Metrics*** 23 (55).
4. **2024 Acosta, Enrique**, Lucia Hug, Helena Cruz-Castanheira, David Sharrow, José Henrique Monteiro da Silva, Danzhen You. "Changes in stillbirths and child and youth mortality in 2020 and 2021 during the Covid-19 pandemic." ***International Journal of Epidemiology*** 53(3).
5. **2024** Alburez-Gutiérrez, Diego*, **Enrique Acosta***, Emilio Zagheni, and Nathalie Williams. "The long-lasting effect of armed conflicts deaths on the living: Quantifying family bereavement." ***Science Advances*** 10(30).
   ***** [Alburez-Gutiérrez and Acosta contributed equally]

6. **2023 Acosta, Enrique**. "Global estimates of excess deaths from COVID-19." ***Nature,*** 613, 31-33.
7. **2022 Acosta, Enrique**, Neil Mehta, Mikko Myrskylä, and Marcus Ebeling. "Cardiovascular Mortality Gap between the United States and other High Life Expectancy Countries during the Period 2000-2016." ***Journal of Gerontology – Social Sciences,*** 77(IS2).
8. **2021** Riffe, Tim*, **Enrique Acosta***, and the COVerAGE-DB Team. "COVerAGE-DB: A Global Database of Age-structured COVID-19 Cases and Deaths." ***International Journal of Epidemiology*** 50(2).
   ***** [Riffe and Acosta contributed equally]
9. **2020** Nepomuceno, Marília R.*, **Enrique Acosta***, Diego Alburez-Gutierrez, José Manuel Aburto, Alain Gagnon, and Cássio M. Turra. "Besides Population Age Structure, Health, and Other Demographic Factors can Contribute to Understanding the COVID-19 Burden." ***Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*** 117(25).
   ***** [Nepomuceno and Acosta contributed equally]
10. **2019 Acosta, Enrique**, S.A. Hallman, N. Ouellette, R. Bourbeau, D.A. Herring, K. Inwood, L. Dillon, D.J. Earn, J. Madrenas, M.S. Miller, A. Gagnon. "Determinants of Influenza Mortality Trends. Age-Period-Cohort Analysis of Influenza Mortality in the United States 1959-2016." ***Demography***, 56 (5).
11. **2019 Acosta, Enrique**, Alyson van Raalte. "APC-Curvature Plots: Displaying Nonlinear Age-Period-Cohort Patterns on Lexis Plots." ***Demographic Research***, 41 (42).

Other selected peer-reviewed publications (complete list here)

12. **2025** Pardo, Ignacio, Nicolás Sacco, **Enrique Acosta**, and Andrés Castro. "Fertility Decline to Low and Lowest-Low Levels in Latin America." ***Population Research and Policy Review*** 44(9).
13. **2024** Meyer, Anna, Marcus Ebeling, **Enrique Acosta**, and Karin Modig. "Impact of the Covid-19 pandemic on the epidemiology of acute myocardial infarction – Population-level trends in incidence rates, hospital admissions, and fatality." ***European Journal of Epidemiology*** (39).
14. **2023** Castro, Andrés F., **Enrique Acosta**, Ignacio Pardo, Nicolás Sacco, Beatriz Piedad Urdinola. "Diverging reproductive outcomes by maternal education during the Covid-19 pandemic across Brazilian and Colombian regions" ***Population, Space and Place***, 30(1).
15. **2022** Ebeling, Marcus, **Enrique Acosta**, Anna Meyer, Hal Caswell, and Karin Modig. "Years of life lost during the Covid-19 pandemic in Sweden considering variation in life expectancy by level of geriatric care." ***European Journal of Epidemiology,*** 37.
16. **2021** Sempé, Lucas, Peter Lloyd-Sherlock, Ramón Martínez, Shah Ebrahim, Martin McKee, **Enrique Acosta**. "Estimation of all-cause excess mortality by age-specific mortality patterns for countries with incomplete vital statistics: a population-based study of the case of Peru during the first wave of the COVID-19 pandemic." ***The Lancet Regional Health – Americas*** 100039.
17. **2020** Dudel, Christian, Tim Riffe, **Enrique Acosta**, Alyson A. van Raalte, Cosmo Strozza, and Mikko Myrskylä. "Monitoring Trends and Differences in COVID-19 Case Fatality Rates Using Decomposition Methods: Contributions of Age Structure and Age-Specific Fatality." ***PLOS ONE***, 15(9): e0238904.
18. **2020** Gagnon, Alain, **Enrique Acosta**, and M.S. Miller. "Age-specific incidence of influenza A responds to the change in virus subtype dominance." ***Clinical Infectious Diseases***, (ciaa075).
19. **2018** Gagnon, Alain, **Enrique Acosta**, S. Hallman, R.R. Bourbeau, L. Dillon, D.J. Earn, D.A. Herring, K. Inwood, J. Madrenas, and M.S. Miller. "Pandemic paradox: Early life pandemic influenza infection enhanced susceptibility to death during the 2009 H1N1 pandemic." ***mBio***, 9 (1).
    ***** [Gagnon, Acosta, and Miller contributed equally]
20. **2018** Gagnon, Alain, **Enrique Acosta**, and M.S. Miller. "Reporting and evaluating influenza virus surveillance data: An argument for incidence by single year of age." ***Vaccine*** 36 (42).

Book chapters

2026 Acosta, Enrique. "Mortality across generations: patterns, mechanisms, and gradients," in "Research Handbook on Population Heterogeneities." Edited by Iñaki Permanyer, Edward Elgar. ISBN 9781035336449.

2026 Alburez-Gutierrez, Diego, and **Enrique Acosta.** "Measuring Bereavement as a Consequence of War," in "Handbook on Conflict and Health." Edited by Amy Hagopian and Marion Birch, De Gruyter. ISBN 9783111250144.

2022 Acosta, Enrique. "La surmortalité des baby-boomers au Canada et aux États-Unis," in "L'éclairage de la démographie : Mesurer pour mieux comprendre les enjeux sociaux." Edited by Victor Piché, Céline Le Bourdais, Richard Marcoux, and Nadine Ouellette. Les Presses de l'Université de Montréal. ISBN 9782760644830.

Institutional reports

2022 - 2026 Leader of analysis of changes in stillbirths and deaths for children and youth during the COVID-19 pandemic for the reports of the *United Nations Inter-agency Group for Child Mortality Estimation (UN-IGME)*: "Levels & Trends in Child Mortality report 2021", 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025, and "Never Forgotten: The situation of stillbirth around the globe 2022."

2023 Acosta, Enrique, Frédéric Fleury-Payeur, and Alexandre Paquette. Méthodologie du modèle d'estimation de la surmortalité. *Institut de la statistique du Québec*.

Public Scholarship

2026 Acosta, Enrique, Diego Alburez-Gutierrez, Irena Chen, Ana Cristina Gómez-Ugarte. "War, So Much War… Death, How Much Death: Two Years of Demographic Collapse in Gaza", *Perspectives Demogràfiques*, 42: 1-4 (ISSN: 2696- 4228). DOI: 10.46710/ced.pd.eng.42.

2024 Alburez-Gutierrez, Diego, and **Enrique Acosta.** "The political, social, and psychological toll of family deaths in war", *The Conversation*. DOI: 10.64628/AAO.n94svvdq5.

Guest Editor

Canadian Studies in Population, Special Issue on *Population Health and COVID-19* (2021)

Working Papers

Acosta, Enrique, Alejandra Romero, Luciana Etcheverry, Luis González, Nadín Medellín, Ercio Muñoz y Oscar Acosta. "Visibilización estadística y estimación demográfica de minorías étnico-raciales en Colombia: evaluación de las fuentes y desafíos conceptuales y metodológicos."

Acosta, Enrique, Alain Gagnon, Nadine Ouellette, Robert Bourbeau, Marília Nepomuceno, and Alyson van Raalte. "The boomer penalty: excess mortality among baby boomers in Canada and the United States." *MPIDR Working Paper Series WP-2020-003*.

Miranda, Maria, Ugofilippo Basellini, **Enrique Acosta**, and Emilio Zagheni. "How period life expectancy can distort our interpretation of mortality crises."

Abrams, Leah, Sha Jiang, Diego Alburez-Gutierrez, **Enrique Acosta**, Emilio Zagheni "Adverse Mortality Trends have Increased the Number Bereaved in the United States."

Funded Projects

Co-Principal Investigator (PI) – "From lifestyle behaviours to ageing: Current mortality challenges in low-mortality settings (BEHAGEING)". *Proyectos de Generación de Conocimiento, Agencia Estatal de Investigación* (Spain), 2024-28. Co-PI: Sergi Trias-Llimós (Universidad Pompeu Fabra). Funding: 103,500€.

Co-Principal Investigator (PI) – "COVerAGE-DB: A global demographic database of COVID-19". *Project at the Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research* (Germany), 2020-2024. Co-PI: Tim Riffe (University of the Basque Country). Funding: 300,000€.

Grants and Fellowships

Postdoctoral Grant, ***Ramón y Cajal*** – *Agencia Estatal de Investigación del Gobierno de España* (2023-2027). Amount: 236,350 EUR.

Postdoctoral Grant, ***Beatriu de Pinós**** – *Generalitat de Catalunya* (2023-2025). Amount: 143,000 EUR.
* Declined for *Ramón y Cajal* postdoctoral grant.

Postdoctoral Grant, ***Fonds de recherche du Québec – Société et Culture*** **(FRQSC)** (2020-2021).* Amount: 110,000 CAD.
* First place. Merged with the SSHRC postdoctoral fellowship.

Postdoctoral Grant, ***Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC)*** *of Canada* (2020-2021). Amount: 90,000 CAD.

Doctoral Grant, ***Joseph-Armand Bombardier***, *Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) of Canada* (2015-2018). Amount: 105,000 CAD.

Doctoral Fellowship, ***Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research***, Laboratories Lifespan Inequalities and Population Health (2018-2019). Amount: 36,000 EUR.

Excellence Scholarship for full Master's studies – ***Universidad Distrital de Bogotá*** (2009-2011). Amount: 15,000 USD.

Awards and Honors

R3 certification of outstanding research trajectory (2026) — Agencia Estatal de Investigación (AEI), Spain (Ramón y Cajal programme).

Excellence award for best doctoral student – Department of Demography, *Université de Montréal* (2020).

Dean's List of Honor – Université de Montréal (2020).

Doctoral thesis selected as the best in the Arts, Human, and Social Sciences category to represent the Université de Montréal at Canada's Distinguished Dissertation Awards ACES/UMI (2020).

Doctoral dissertation with the mention of *Exceptional*, the highest distinction, Department of Demography, *Université de Montréal* (2019).

National Government & University Distinctions for Top Graduating Industrial Engineer (Top 0.2% in Colombia, Honors Thesis), 2007.

Academic Event Committees

International Workshop on Latin American Health and Mortality, Organizer, Montevideo, 2025
Summer program Incubator 2025, Mentor, Rostock, 2025
Rostock Retreat on Data Visualization, Organizer, Rostock, 2021

Invited Talks

A complete list is available on request. I have been invited to give talks at the *UN-IGME-TAG*; the *WHO Technical Advisory Group (TAG) on COVID-19 Mortality Assessment*; *Instituto Brasileño de Geografía y Estadística (IBGE)*, Brazil; Space-Time Analysis Bayes (STAB) group at the *University of Washington*, *Institut national d'études démographiques–INED*, France, *Max Planck for Demographic Research–MPIDR*, Germany, the *Leverhulme Centre for Demographic Science* at the *University of Oxford*, the *WHO-Johns Hopkins University CA-CODE* group, at the UN-RGHS Task Force on all-cause mortality and life table estimation, US; *Inter American Development Bank – IDB*; *Colmex, Centro de Estudios Demográficos, Urbanos y Ambientales – CEDUA*, Mexico; Congreso Internacional de la ALAP, Chile 2022 and Colombia 2024; *Universidad Nacional de Córdoba*, Argentina; *Asian Demographic Research Institute* at the *Shanghai University*, China; Department of demography at the *Université de Montréal*, Canada; *Universidade Federal de Minas de Gerais–Cedeplar*, Brazil; *Programa de Población–Universidad de la República*, Uruguay; and *Demographic Conference of Young Demographers–Charles University*, Czech Republic.

Conferences

The full list is available on request. I have given oral and poster presentations at large international, European, and Northern American demography conferences, including the International Population Conference (**IPC**) of the International Union for the Scientific Study of Population (**IUSSP**), the Population Association of America Annual Meeting (**PAA**), the European Population Conference (**EPC**), the Congreso Internacional de la Asociación Latinoamericana de Población (**ALAP**), EAPS Health, Morbidity and Mortality Working Group (**HMMWG**), Réseau espérance de vie en santé (**REVES)**, The Colloque de l'Association des démographes du Québec (**ADQ**), the Federation of Canadian Demographers Conference (**FCD**), and the Conference of the European Society of Historical Demography (**ESHD**).

Doctoral Students

Completed

Adarsh (U. St-Andrews, UK – MPIDR, Germany) 2021–2026 (Ph.D. defended 2026)
Thesis topic: Age-Period-Cohort patterns of mortality from substance abuse in high-income countries.

Ongoing

Gonzalo de Armas (U. de la República, Uruguay) 2022–.
Topic: Mortality transitions in Latin American populations.

Daniel Perea (Centre d'Estudis Demogràfics – Universidad Autónoma de Barcelona, Spain) 2025–.
Topic: Suicides and Substance abuse mortality.

Kaustav Chakraborty (Centre d'Estudis Demogràfics – Universidad Autónoma de Barcelona, Spain) 2025–.
Topic: Trends in mental health disorders and the care burden.

Thesis Advisory Committee

Maria Gargiulo (*The London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine – LSHTM,* UK) 2025–. Topic: Conflict and violence-related mortality.

Lilibeth Romero Mendoza (*COLMEX,* México) 2025–. Topic: Armed Conflict and Sexual and Reproductive Health in Colombia.

Enrique Perez (*Center for Demographic Studies* and *Universidad Autónoma de Barcelona*, Spain) 2024–. Topic: Cardiovascular mortality trends in Spain and Europe.

Thesis Evaluation Committee

Hampton Gaddy (PhD, London School of Economics), examiner 2026
Harold Mera (PhD, Universidad Pompeu Fabra), examiner 2024
Paula Castro (PhD, Centre d'Estudis Demogràfics - CED), examiner 2024
Florencia Bathory (MSc, Universidad Nacional de Luján), examiner 2024
Maria Gargiulo (MSc, European Doctoral School in Demography), examiner 2024
Maria Laura Lopes Miranda (MSc, UFMG - CEDEPLAR), examiner 2023
Amanda Martins (MSc, European Doctoral School in Demography), examiner 2023
Giacomo Baldi (MSc, European Doctoral School in Demography), examiner 2023

Teaching Experience

Lecturer

European Doctoral School of Demography (EDSD) - *Master's program*
- *Analysis of Mortality Disturbances* – 2023–Ongoing

International Max Planck Research School for Population, Health and Data Science (IMPRS-PHDS) - *Doctoral program*
- *Mortality Trends* – 2019-2022

Universidad de la República de Uruguay (UDELAR) - Programa de población - *Master's program*
- *Demographic Analysis of Mortality* – 2022

Invited Lecturer

February 2022 – *Université de Montréal*, Department of Demography, Montreal, Canada.
November 2021 – *Universidad Nacional de Córdoba*, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas, Postdoctoral Program in Demography, Córdoba, Argentina.
October 2021 – *Universidad de la República de Uruguay*, Programa de Población. Master's in Demography, Montevideo, Uruguay.
April 2016 – *Departamento Administrativo Nacional de Estadística – DANE*, Equipo de Proyecciones de Población y Análisis Demográfico, Bogotá, Colombia.

Selected Press Coverage

Le Monde (2026), The Guardian (2026), TRT (2025), Nature Middle East (2024), Haaretz (2024), *Deutsche Welle* (2023), *El Mundo* (2023), *El País* (2021), *Fantástico* (2021), *Liberation* (2020), *The Guardian* (2020), *Nature Medicine* (2020), *Les Echos* (2020), *Alternatives Économiques* (2020), *El País* (2020), *El Espectador* (2020). *Nexo* (2020), *Associated Press* (2020).

Scientific Evaluation

2026 ALAP (San José), Scientific Committee.
2025 I Seminario Latinoamericano de Salud y Mortalidad (Montevideo), Scientific Committee.
2024 International Population Conference - IPC-IUSSP (Brisbane), Scientific Committee.
2024 European Population Conference (Edinburgh), Convener of Health, Morbidity and Wellbeing
2024 European Consortium of Sociological Research (ECSR) (Barcelona), Scientific Committee.
2024 REVES meeting (Bogotá), Scientific Committee.
2024 ALAP (Bogotá), Scientific Committee.
2023 Postdoctoral Grants, Juan de la Cierva, Agencia Estatal de Investigación de España.
2020 BRAIN-be 2.0 research program, Belgian Science Policy Office.

Journals Reviewed for

Top journals in multidisciplinary domains (*Nature, Science Advances, PNAS*), in demography (*Demography, Population and Development Review, European Journal of Population, Demographic Research*), epidemiology (*International Journal of Epidemiology, American Journal of Epidemiology*), and public health (*American Journal of Public Health, Health Affairs*), among others.

Languages: English (Fluent); French (Fluent); Spanish (Native)

Other Experience

Member of the *Technical Advisory Council of the National Statistical System in Colombia* – *CASEN* (2025-2027).
Member of the *Technical Advisory Group of the UN Inter-agency Group for Child Mortality Estimation* – *IGME-TAG* (2023-).
Inter-American Development Bank – IDB - Analysis of ethnic and racial classification in different sources of statistical information in Colombia (2024 - 2025).
UN-UNICEF – Leader of the analysis of excess stillbirths and deaths for children and youth during the COVID-19 pandemic, and the work on crisis adjustments, and TAG member at the United Nations Inter-Agency Group for Child Mortality Estimation (UN-IGME) (2021-2025) for the *Levels & Trends in Child Mortality Reports* in 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025.
UN-WHO – Observer member of the WHO Technical Advisory Group (TAG) on COVID-19 Mortality Assessment (2021-2025).
Institut de la statistique du Québec – Methodological design for the measurement of the excess mortality from all causes of death (2021).
Administrative National Department of Statistics of Colombia (DANE) – Demographic consultant team member for mortality estimation methodology. (2016). Under the direction of Robert Bourbeau, Ph.D., and Simona Bignami, Ph.D.
Université de Montréal – Research Assistant (2013 – 2018)